

STAGE FOURTEEN • PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Fourteen • Project Management

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what's your project's scope, risk register, or timeline?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of projects going right or wrong?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

Most participants have real project experience, formal or informal, group projects, work tasks, even planning a personal event, to draw on here. Encourage concrete stories over general opinions about project management.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Project Planning Foundations

"Has a project you were part of ever failed specifically because of unclear scope, not lack of effort? What actually happened?"

"What's a time you assumed a stakeholder's request meant one thing, only to discover later they actually needed something different?"

"Have you ever been part of a project where a genuine risk was identified early but nobody actually planned for it? What happened when it hit?"

"What's the most useful timeline or plan you've ever seen — what made it more useful than a typical one?"

SESSION 2

Managing Execution

"Have you ever been on a project where one stakeholder was completely out of the loop while another was overloaded with updates? What would you change about that?"

"Describe a time a project's scope quietly grew without anyone formally deciding it should. How did that happen?"

"Has a project budget or schedule ever gone stale — no longer reflecting reality — because updating it felt uncomfortable? What happened?"

"What's a project management tool or system you've used that genuinely made a real difference, versus one that just added overhead?"

SESSION 3

Modern Methodologies & Closing Out

"Have you been part of a team that adapted its plan based on real feedback partway through? What made that possible?"

"Describe a time you needed to escalate something but hesitated. What held you back, and what happened when you finally did?"

"Has a project you were part of ever just quietly faded out instead of formally closing? What real value was lost by not closing it properly?"

"Looking back across this whole stage, which part of managing a project feels most natural to you, and which still feels like genuine, ongoing work?"